

Workshop: Implementing Agile Methodology in Your IT Team

Introduction

Welcome to today's workshop! Our objective is to **collaboratively develop a memorandum** that introduces Agile methodology to your IT team. You will learn key Agile principles, relevant vocabulary, and practical communication strategies to ensure your team successfully transitions to this new way of working.

Objectives of Today's Workshop:

- Understand the Agile methodology and its benefits
 - Learn essential Agile and IT vocabulary
 - Develop a structured and engaging memorandum
 - Practice handling resistance to change through interactive exercises
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Step 1: Understanding Agile Methodology

Observe, comment and define

This is an illustration of Agile compared to the traditional way of working. Describe the different steps and compare the two methodologies.

Definition :

'Agile methodology is a list of principles and ideas that help businesses be more flexible and adaptable in the organization of their work. It comprises its own lexicon

and routine / schedule to know and respect in order to be more efficient. '

Here are 2 links that can help you with the basics :

-presentation of agile methodology

<https://zenkit.com/en/blog/agile-methodology-an-overview/>

-how to use agile?

<https://www.wikihow.com/Use-Agile-Methodology>

The Project: Writing a Team Memorandum

Your goal is to draft a **clear and convincing memorandum** that explains to your team:

- **What Agile methodology is** and why the team is adopting it
- **The roles and responsibilities** within an Agile team
- **How the work process will change** (e.g., sprints, daily stand-ups, backlog management)

You can include:

Diagrams to illustrate the workflow

Charts to compare Agile vs. traditional methods

Examples of how Agile will be applied in your team

What is Agile Methodology?

Agile is a **flexible, iterative approach** to project management, emphasizing **collaboration, adaptability, and customer feedback**. Unlike traditional project management, Agile promotes **continuous improvement** and quick response to changes.

Read more:

- [Agile Overview](#)
- [How to Use Agile](#)

Step 2: Grammar & Vocabulary Essentials

To write an effective memorandum, you will need:

Grammar Focus

Modals (to describe team roles and responsibilities)

[Practice here](#)

Future Tenses (to explain upcoming changes)

[Will vs. Going to](#)

Conditionals (to discuss the consequences of Agile adoption)

[Mixed Conditionals](#)

Key Vocabulary

IT & Agile Terms – [Glossary](#)

Decision-Making & Persuasion – [Useful phrases](#)

Negotiation Skills – Business English Phrases

Step 3: Analyzing Agile vs. Traditional Workflows

Below is an illustration comparing **Agile vs. Traditional** project management.

Your Task:

- **Describe** the differences between the two approaches
 - **Identify** the advantages of Agile
 - **Discuss** how this will impact your IT team's work structure
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Step 4: Writing the Memorandum

Now that you understand Agile, let's put it into practice!

Your Task:

Write a **formal memorandum** introducing Agile to your team.

Structure your memo as follows:

1. **Introduction** – Explain the reason for this change
2. **What is Agile?** – Briefly define Agile methodology
3. **How Agile will be implemented** – Outline new team roles, processes, and expectations
4. **Benefits** – Highlight how this will improve productivity and efficiency
5. **Call to Action** – Encourage your team to embrace the change

Tip: Use modals, future tenses, and conditionals for clarity!

Exercise: Handling Resistance to Change (Agile Methodology)

Objective:

Help ESL students in IT practice expressing ideas in writing and develop their ability to explain Agile methodology through written communication with skeptical colleagues.

Scenario:

Your company is transitioning to Agile methodology, but some team members are resistant. They are used to traditional workflows and believe Agile will create unnecessary complications. Your task is to persuade them through a written conversation, addressing their concerns in a structured and professional manner.

Step 1: Understanding the Scenario

- Imagine you are introducing Agile methodology to your IT team through a written exchange.
 - A team member is skeptical and challenges the necessity of Agile.
 - Your goal is to convince them of Agile's benefits using clear, persuasive writing.
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Step 2: Writing an Effective Opening Message

Before engaging in the written exchange, your first task is to write a detailed and structured opening message. Your message should:

1. **Clearly introduce the topic** (e.g., "Our team is transitioning to Agile, and I'd like to explain why this will benefit us.")
2. **Acknowledge potential concerns** (e.g., "I understand that Agile might seem like a major shift from our current process.")
3. **Present a persuasive argument** (e.g., "However, Agile allows us to adapt quickly to changes and improve collaboration, leading to better project outcomes.")

Example Opening Message:

"Hi [Colleague's Name], I wanted to take a moment to talk about our transition to Agile methodology. I understand that moving away from our traditional workflow may seem unnecessary, but Agile can help us work more efficiently and adapt to project changes in real time. It encourages better collaboration and faster delivery. I'd love to hear your thoughts on this change and address any concerns you might have. Let's discuss!"

Your Task:

Write your own opening message before moving to the next step. Submit it for validation before proceeding.

Step 3: Exchanging Written Messages

Once your opening message is validated, engage in a written conversation with a partner (or AI) who will play the role of a skeptical team member. Respond to their objections clearly and convincingly.

Focus on:

- Writing persuasively
- Addressing concerns logically and respectfully
- Using appropriate Agile vocabulary

Step 4: Discussion & Reflection

After completing the written exchange, reflect on the experience:

- What objections were the most challenging to address in writing?
- How did you structure your responses?
- What strategies helped you be more persuasive?

Pair Up and Share:

- Exchange your conversation logs with a partner.
 - Discuss which arguments were most effective and why.
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Wrap-Up & Next Steps

You Have:

- ✓ Practiced explaining Agile in writing
- ✓ Developed persuasive communication skills
- ✓ Learned to handle resistance through written dialogue

Next Steps:

- Finalize a written summary of Agile's benefits for your team.
- Get feedback from peers on your written exchanges.
- Continue practicing written persuasion using AI tools or peer discussions.

Discussion Question:

What challenges do you anticipate when implementing Agile, and how can you address them in writing?